Old Qandahar region in the south was ensconced within networks linking the Indic and Iranian worlds since at least the early first millennium CE.[97] Not only did these regions serve as stages upon which an obscure clan, originating in the region's nomad–urban continuum, coalesced as imperial lineages; they also adumbrate the Shansabanis' ingenious reuse of inherited landscapes replete with the remains of rich and deep histories (see also Chapter 1).

Indeed, all three areas must also be recuperated from the elisions and silences of textual sources. Past authors' virtual erasure of the Shansabanis' origins in the transhumance/nomadism of Ghur – and everything else that was erased alongside – have already been discussed (see Chapters 1 and 2). But a similar silence surrounding the Shansabanis' reuse and repurposing of pre-Islamic sites and structures in the Bamiyan region is difficult to ignore. Indeed, without the analysis of the surviving architectural remains at Firuzkuh and Bamiyan, knowledge of Shansabani presences there would be limited to the perfunctory textual mentions of the cultural patronage incumbent upon Perso-Islamicate rulers, with no intimation of their remapping of the geo-political terrain as they contended with new adversaries. And without even the sparse archaeological data from Tiginabad/Old Qandahar, insight into the impetuses behind the Shansabani campaigns into al-Rukkhaj-Zamindawar would be altogether unrecoverable.

It bears reiteration that the Bamiyan Shansabanis in particular might have conformed to their specific local requirements for maintaining power by constructing palaces. This architectural patronage, arguably quite new for a Shansabani clan, did not preclude reoccupation and repurposing of a built environment, making the reuse in Bamiyan really a continuation of the collective Shansabanis' pre-imperial transhumant/nomadic practices (see Chapter 2). The simultaneity of these seemingly divergent ways of shaping a landscape actually encapsulates the *real* complexity of the nomad–urban continuum, wherein populations adapted to their changing circumstances with surprising alacrity. In their respective continuities and adaptations, the Shansabani imprints at early Firuzkuh, Bamiyan, and Tiginabad/Old Qandahar prefigure the subsequent, place-specific empire-building that the lately established *third* branch – the Ghazna Shansabanis – undertook throughout farther-flung conquests eastward to the Indus and beyond (cf. esp. Chapter 6, and Volume II).

Furthermore, by the 1170s it could be said that there was no singular Shansabani elite, but rather separate and even competing agnatic lineages at Firuzkuh, Bamiyan, and eventually Ghazna (cf. Chapters 4 and 5). The fragmentation of inheritance, customary among modern nomadic groups (cf. Chapters 1 and 2), could in fact be suggestive of the increasing politico-economic independence of these various Shansabani lineages. Seniority, however, rested ostensibly with Ghiyath al-Din and the Firuzkuh Shansabanis: this branch was part of a *westward* geo-historical momentum